

Course guide for EU2210 - European Environment and Energy

Fall 2025

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Introduction

Welcome to the course European Environment and Energy! The course is given within the Master's programme in European Studies (two-year programme) and is a semi-elective course. Responsible department for this course is the Department of Political Science. The course addresses and problematizes the EU's environmental and energy policy. This provides the baseline for thematic elaborations on different environmental and energy problems and future challenges for the EU.

The discussions are organized around the policy process, focusing on: (1) the demand for public policy; (2) the roles of various actors, institutions, and interests in the public policy adoption process; and (3) implementation and compliance challenges, particularly the relationship between the EU and its member states.

The assignments are designed to give students the opportunity to: identify and formulate compelling scientific questions; critically review and summarize existing research; reflect on theory and theoretical frameworks and refine research questions to ensure they are precise and researchable.

Below in this document you will find the expected learning outcomes from the course, and a description of how you are examined. You are asked to come to the seminars and lectures well-prepared.

We hope that you will find the course interesting!

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Objectives (from course syllabus)

A student who has passed the course will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- demonstrate in-depth knowledge of the political conditions for environmental and energy policymaking in Europe.

Competence and skills

- analyze specific environmental and energy issues within the context of European policy.
- effectively present and advocate for own and independent analyses of European environmental and energy policies, both verbally and in written form.
- search for and critically summarize research literature concerning the study of European environmental and energy policies.
- formulate and argue for interesting research problems within the field of European environment and energy policy.
- independently produce text in accordance with good academic practice, including proper citation technique and use of references.
- communicate clearly and proficiently in English both orally and in writing.

Judgement and approach

- evaluate and criticize research results and theories investigating European environment and energy policy.
- take part in reflective discussions of existing research on European environment and energy policy.

Course structure - Themes

This course examines the political conditions that shape environmental and energy policymaking in Europe. While engaging with the core themes of policy and governance, you will also develop essential research and analytical skills. Strengthening these competencies alongside your subject knowledge will enhance your ability to formulate and write a high-quality Master's Thesis. By working systematically with complex social and political issues, you will cultivate a deeper and more critical understanding of the field.

The course is structured around four thematic modules. Themes 1 through 3 are designed to help you practice key academic skills: identifying and formulating relevant scientific questions, critically engaging with previous research, and refining your analytical abilities. These three themes build a foundation for the fourth and final theme, in which you will draft a tentative outline for your Master's Thesis.

Each theme includes specific instructions and activities, which are detailed below. For Themes 1–3, we outline the capabilities that will be trained in each. In Theme 4, you will integrate and apply all of these skills. Below you will find an overview of how seminars, examinations, and written assignments are linked to each theme.

Themes	Seminars and exams	Credits
Theme 1		
Policy adoption <i>Identify an interesting societal/scientific problem</i>	Tutorial poster seminar Poster seminar	3.5
Theme 2		
Policy demand <i>Critically summarize current research on a specific societal problem</i>	Literature review seminar	
Theme 3		
Policy implementation <i>Evaluate and discuss theory and theoretical perspectives</i>	Theory and RQ seminar	
Theme 4		
Master thesis proposal <i>Putting it all together into a Master thesis proposal</i>	Tutorial seminar Exam Final paper seminar Final paper	3.5 3.5 4.5

You are expected to present your work orally during the course seminars, using slides (theme 4) and a poster (theme 1). Furthermore, you are expected to, in the group to which you are assigned, read *all* your fellow students' texts carefully and prepare to take active part in the discussion. However, you will be assigned the role of a commentator for two papers/posters. This means that you, together with a fellow student, shall lead a critical discussion about the papers in question. Please make sure to read through carefully the checklist below, in order to prepare yourself the best you could for the seminars.

The purpose is to train your ability for oral argumentation, and to do this while deliberating with other students, which has the potential of strengthening your argumentative and analytical skills. Another purpose is to get access to other students' work and thoughts, which will broaden your understanding for the themes of the course. Please remember that your achievements at the seminars affect your grade.

Lectures and literature

Our primary course textbook is *Environmental Policy in the EU: Actors, Institutions, and Processes* by Andrew Jordan and Viviane Gravey (4th Edition, 2021, London: Routledge). In addition to this textbook, you are required to read specific research articles and book chapters that correspond to each lecture. Below is a list of the lectures and the associated readings. Please ensure you come to class prepared by completing the assigned readings in advance.

Introductory lectures
The history of European environmental and energy politics, Niklas Harring <i>Literature:</i> Jordan & Gravey (2021) Chapters 2, 16, 19, 20. Jagers, Sverker. C., Harring, Niklas., Löfgren, Åsa., Sjöstedt, Martin., (2020). On the preconditions for large-scale collective action. <i>Ambio</i>, 49(7), 1282-1296.
Introduction to EU institutions and decision-making, Monika de Silva, <i>Suggested literature:</i> Jordan & Gravey (2021) Chapters 5,6,7,8,9
Academic writing , Kristin Clay
Theme 1: Policy adoption: Actors, institutions, processes, and interest constellations
Introduction + The European energy challenges, Urban Strandberg <i>Literature:</i> Jordan & Gravey (2021) Chapter 11 Strandberg, Urban (2010) 'Editorial: Energy supply and security policy. In the need of transnational institutions?', <i>Energy Policy</i>, 38:3, pp.1227-1229 Umbach, Frank (2010) 'Global energy security and the implications for the EU', <i>Energy Policy</i>, 38:3, pp. 1229-1240.
Interest constellations and energy policy: Nuclear Power and Nuclear Waste, Urban Strandberg <i>Literature:</i> Strandberg, Urban. & Andrén, Mats. (2009) 'Editorial: Nuclear Waste Management in a Globalized World', in <i>Journal of Risk Research</i>, 12:7-8, pp. 879-895; Strandberg, Urban (2011) 'Seven principles, two unreasonable objectives, and one lingering predicament: unavailing endeavors to bring about legitimate management of spent nuclear fuel and high-level radioactive waste', Conceptual paper submitted to the Blue Ribbon Commission on America's Nuclear Future, June 28. Darst, Robert.G. & Dawson, Jane.I. (2008) 'Baptists and Bootleggers, Once Removed: The Politics of Exploring Radioactive Waste Internalization in the European Union', <i>Global Environmental Politics</i>, 8:2, pp. 17-39.

Högselius, Per. (2009) 'Spent nuclear fuel policies in historical perspective: An international comparison', <i>Energy Policy</i>, 37:1, pp. 254-263. Brunnengräber, Achim & Miranda Schreurs (2015) 'Nuclear Energy and Nuclear Waste Governance Perspectives after the Fukushima Nuclear Disaster', in Eds. Brunnengräber, A., Di Nucci, M.R., Isidoro Losada, A.M., Mez, L., Schreurs, M.A., <i>Nuclear Waste Governance - An International Comparison</i>, Springer, pp. 25-43. Di Nucci, Maria Rosaria (et al.) (2015) 'An Open Door for Spent Fuel and Radioactive Waste Export?' in Eds. Brunnengräber, A., Di Nucci, M.R., Isidoro Losada, A.M., Mez, L., Schreurs, M.A., <i>Nuclear Waste Governance - An International Comparison</i>, Springer, pp. 25-43. Jordan & Gravey (2021) Chapter 11
Theme 2: Policy demand
Introduction Theme 2
The principle-implementation gap of environmental policy instruments in Europe, Niklas Harring Jordan & Gravey (2021), Chapters 17,18,19 Andre, P., Boneva, T., Chopra, F., & Falk, A. (2024). Globally representative evidence on the actual and perceived support for climate action. <i>Nature Climate Change</i> Bergquist, M., Nilsson, A., Harring, N. & Jagers, S.C (2022). Meta-analyses of fifteen determinants of public opinion about climate change taxes and laws. <i>Nature Climate Change</i> 12, 235–240 Davidovic, D., Harring, N., & Jagers, Sverker C. (2019). The contingent effects of environmental concern and ideology: institutional context and people's willingness to pay environmental taxes. <i>Environmental Politics</i> 29(4): 674-696. Harring, Niklas. (2014). "Corruption, inequalities and the perceived effectiveness of economic pro-environmental policy instruments: A European cross-national study." <i>Environmental Science & Policy</i> 39: 119-128. Maestre-Andrés, S., Drews, S., & Van den Bergh, J. (2019). Perceived fairness and public acceptability of carbon pricing: a review of the literature. <i>Climate policy</i>, 19(9), 1186-1204
Varieties of environmental policy instruments and policy demand in Europe, Niklas Harring Jordan & Gravey (2021), Chapters 17,18,19 Andre, P., Boneva, T., Chopra, F., & Falk, A. (2024). Globally representative evidence on the actual and perceived support for climate action. <i>Nature Climate Change</i> Bergquist, M., Nilsson, A., Harring, N. & Jagers, S.C (2022). Meta-analyses of fifteen determinants of public opinion about climate change taxes and laws. <i>Nature Climate Change</i> 12, 235–240 Davidovic, D., Harring, N., & Jagers, Sverker C. (2019). The contingent effects of environmental concern and ideology: institutional context and people's willingness to pay environmental taxes. <i>Environmental Politics</i> 29(4): 674-696. Harring, Niklas. (2014). "Corruption, inequalities and the perceived effectiveness of economic pro-environmental policy instruments: A European cross-national study." <i>Environmental Science & Policy</i> 39: 119-128.

Maestre-Andrés, S., Drews, S., & Van den Bergh, J. (2019). Perceived fairness and public acceptability of carbon pricing: a review of the literature. *Climate policy*, 19(9), 1186-1204

Theme 3: Policy implementation and compliance

Introduction Theme 3 + Implementation & Compliance I, Olof Larsson

Literature:

Jordan & Gravey (2021) Chapter 12, 13, 17 & 19

Kelemen, R Daniel, and Tommaso Pavone. 'Where Have the Guardians Gone? Law Enforcement and the Politics of Supranational Forbearance in the European Union'. *World Politics* 75, no. 4 (2023): 779–825.

Maris, Georgios, and Floros Flouros. 'The Green Deal, National Energy and Climate Plans in Europe: Member States' Compliance and Strategies'. *Administrative Sciences* 11, no. 3 (2021): 75.

Fjelstul, Joshua C., and Clifford J. Carrubba. 'The Politics of International Oversight: Strategic Monitoring and Legal Compliance in the European Union'. *American Political Science Review*, March 2018, 1–17.

Tallberg, Jonas. 'Paths to Compliance: Enforcement, Management, and the European Union'. *International Organization* 56, no. 3 (July 2002): 609–43.

Implementation & Compliance II, Olof Larsson

Literature:

Jordan & Gravey (2021) Chapter 12, 13, 17 & 19

Kelemen, R Daniel, and Tommaso Pavone. 'Where Have the Guardians Gone? Law Enforcement and the Politics of Supranational Forbearance in the European Union'. *World Politics* 75, no. 4 (2023): 779–825.

Maris, Georgios, and Floros Flouros. 'The Green Deal, National Energy and Climate Plans in Europe: Member States' Compliance and Strategies'. *Administrative Sciences* 11, no. 3 (2021): 75.

Fjelstul, Joshua C., and Clifford J. Carrubba. 'The Politics of International Oversight: Strategic Monitoring and Legal Compliance in the European Union'. *American Political Science Review*, March 2018, 1–17.

Tallberg, Jonas. 'Paths to Compliance: Enforcement, Management, and the European Union'. *International Organization* 56, no. 3 (July 2002): 609–43.

Theme 4: Introduction to Master's Thesis Proposal

Introduction theme 4, Niklas Harring

Examination

Assessment in this course consists of oral presentations, a written exam, and an individual written paper on a given topic. Students will also create a poster and

participate in seminar discussions, where they will present their own work and engage with the work of fellow students.

Requirements

The grading scale comprises High Pass (VG), Pass (G) and Fail (U). In order to obtain *Pass* you must fulfill all the learning outcomes (see above) implying pass on all assignments. Both oral and written skills are evaluated.

For a *High Pass*, the work should show a very good ability to connect theoretical analyses to practical outcomes, a good, independent analytical ability and fulfil high academic standards in terms of structure and language. In order to receive a High Pass on the entire course, at least 50 % of the credits need to be graded High Pass.

Hard deadlines on Canvas apply, so be sure to send in papers on time. In case of a missed deadline, the student is referred to the re-take examination.

Language, style, and references

A stringent and concise language is requested. Make sure that the reader can tell when it is your arguments and when you present someone else's arguments. Make active use of references (you can choose the Oxford or the Harvard referencing system, but be consistent), we expect you to indicate page number(s) when referencing. When writing the assignments you are expected to use and refer to academic literature, both from the course list and from other sources.

Seminars, Exams, and Written Assignments

Below you will find instructions for the seminars, examinations, and written assignments included in the course.

1. Tutorial Poster Seminar

Please read the detailed instructions under section 2. *Poster Seminar and Hand-in* below. Based on those guidelines, you are expected to submit a draft proposal ahead of the seminar. There are no formal requirements for this initial draft, its purpose is to allow you to pitch and develop your ideas for discussion.

During the seminar, you will present and discuss your ideas with your peers and contribute constructively to their work as well. This tutorial seminar offers a valuable opportunity to receive feedback in a collaborative environment, through group discussions led by one or two lecturers.

To benefit fully from the seminar, you are expected to arrive well-prepared and actively engage in the discussions with thoughtful comments and questions.

Responsible teacher: Urban Strandberg

2. Poster seminar and hand-in: “Wow this is interesting”! Identify and argue for a thrilling environmental and energy problem worthy of social science research

Energy and environmental policymaking in Europe entails that many actors try to influence the policy process within the frame of the EU-institutions. Some actors may even try to pursue their specific interest by trying to change the EU-institutions.

The task for this assignment is to launch a thrilling European environmental or energy related problem that you think is pressing for a sustainable development. It is up to you to choose a specific problem where stakes are high, where actors' interests are contested, and which you think is worth analysing social scientifically. You launch your problem through an argumentation substantiated by recent research.

To stir your mind and tease your imagination here are some hypothetical examples for tentatively researchable problems. How does various actors try to influence EU policy with the goal to profit or stop profitability from the fracking method to extract oil or natural gas? How does various actors try to influence EU policy with the goal to profit or stop profitability from the use pesticides like glyphosate in farming? How does various actors try to influence EU policy with the goal to profit or stop profitability from extensive off or on shore wind mill development? How does various

actors try to influence EU policy with the goal to promote European corporations' competitiveness with Chinese producers regarding solar energy technology or batteries for electric vehicles?

This is examined through a poster exhibition in the entrance lobby of Sprängkullsgatan 19. You produce a poster that launch a social science research problem, pitch the problem to the other students in the course by orally presenting the poster, and comment on another student's poster. Your poster should consist of four A3 pages printed in colour.

Whereas the substance goal is to train you in bringing on well-grounded arguments for a social science research problem that you find thrilling, the format goal is to train your oral and visual presentation skills. To spark the curiosity and engagement among the poster exhibition attendants, and thus achieve a convincing pitch, your poster should preferably include pictures, graphic illustrations, sub-headings, colours, bulleted points, and the text should be in huge font and only come as single words and short phrases/sentences.

Higher educational credits: 3.5

Scope: A poster made up by four A3 pages printed in colour and pitched in an exhibition.

Poster exhibition: You and the other students will be distributed into four posters pitching groups and walk the exhibition together engaging in one poster pitch at a time.

Preparation: By the start of your posters pitching group's time slot, along with the other students you arrange your poster on portable stands placed in the lobby entrance of Sprängkullsgatan 19. You are also expected to have gone through a fellow student's poster and prepared questions and comments.

Responsible teacher: Urban Strandberg

3. Tutorial seminar: Critically summarize previous research

In this theme, you are expected to critically engage with existing academic research related to your chosen topic within the field of European environmental or energy policy. The aim is to identify, analyze, and synthesize key scholarly contributions in a way that will inform and strengthen the literature review section of your final paper.

Select at least four peer-reviewed research articles that are directly relevant to your chosen issue. For each article, assess its main contributions, identifying both strengths and limitations. In addition, examine how the selected articles relate to one another, considering their content, methodological approaches, and theoretical frameworks.

Your analysis should emphasize why these particular articles are significant for your topic and how they collectively contribute to your understanding of the research field. Pay particular attention to the ways in which the studies are conceptually and empirically interconnected, and how they help you to refine your own research focus.

This tutorial seminar is designed as an opportunity to receive formative feedback that will help you refine your final paper. You are encouraged to make the most of this by preparing a concise and structured presentation.

Presentation Guidelines: You are recommended to focus on four core articles and present your findings using two PowerPoint slides:

- Slide 1: A simple list of the selected articles (properly referenced).
- Slide 2: A synthesis of the most relevant insights, issues, or themes that these articles raise in relation to your topic.

To guide your presentation and discussion, consider the following questions:

- What research questions have been addressed in the literature? Which issues remain underexplored or neglected?
- What are the main findings, conclusions, and arguments presented?
- Where do scholars agree, and where do they diverge in their perspectives or interpretations?
- What accounts for these differences—e.g., theoretical frameworks, methodologies, or empirical evidence?
- Which theories, policies, or data are examined, and what relevant alternatives are missing?
- Are the studies methodologically sound and logically argued? Are there reasons to question their findings?

- What is the overall quality and coherence of the literature? What cumulative knowledge has been established?
- What significant gaps or unresolved problems call for further research?
- How confident can we be in the prevailing claims and arguments, acknowledging the provisional nature of scientific knowledge?
- Who are the authors—what academic or professional backgrounds do they represent (e.g., law, engineering, social sciences)?
- How did you identify and select these particular articles?
- What are the main strengths and weaknesses of these sources?
- Why is this topic significant and worth studying?
- Do the selected articles build upon or cite each other? Do they represent a coherent body of work?
- Is your topic currently too broad, and if so, how might you narrow it for more focused analysis?

Responsible teacher: Niklas Harring

4. Tutorial seminar: Evaluating theoretical perspectives and specifying a research question

The purpose of this assignment is to help you begin formulating a research-worthy problem that is politically, socially, economically, and/or legally significant within the context of European environmental or energy policy. The goal is to explore and reflect on different theoretical perspectives and use them to develop a clear and focused research question.

You are welcome to choose a topic that interests you—this could be one you’ve worked on earlier in the course or a new one entirely, such as climate change, fisheries, biodiversity, energy supply, or renewable energy. The key is that it should be clearly related to an environmental or energy issue within Europe, and formulated in a way that allows for meaningful analysis.

Try to articulate why your research question is relevant and worth investigating. This involves linking your topic to theoretical ideas and showing how your question connects to broader academic or policy debates. Part of the exercise is to think through how theory helps us understand the issue and why this issue matters.

In your text, aim to explain why your chosen topic fits with your question and offer a reasoned discussion that addresses the question itself. Bring in arguments to support your line of thinking, but also consider opposing views or uncertainties—this will help sharpen your analysis and make your reasoning more robust.

Feel free to draw on both course readings and other academic sources that help you develop your ideas. The main purpose here is to explore, reflect, and prepare for your final paper, so use this as a chance to try things out and get feedback.

Also, keep in mind the general expectations around structure, referencing, and academic style that apply to all written assignments in the course.

Be aware that the skill outcomes, formalities, and style requirements, specified above, applies to all written assignments.

Scope: max 1500 words.

Responsible teacher: Olof Larsson

5. Tutorial seminar: A tentative outline of a Master’s Thesis Proposal

Read the detailed instructions in section 7. *Seminar and Hand-in: Tentative Outline of a Master’s Thesis* below. Based on these guidelines, you are expected to submit a draft outline (no specific formal requirements) in which you pitch your thesis idea. During the seminar, you will present and discuss your proposal, and are also

expected to actively engage with and provide constructive feedback on the work of your fellow students.

This seminar is designed to support your preparation for the final exam and the writing of your final paper, your Master's Thesis proposal. It offers a valuable opportunity to practice oral presentation skills, critically reflect on your project from a theoretical perspective, and refine your research focus.

The seminar will be chaired by a lecturer but is primarily structured as a peer-learning exercise. Together, we will explore and discuss each other's ideas in an open and collaborative setting. You are also welcome to pose questions to the group regarding your project.

This process not only helps you develop and clarify your thinking but also improves the overall quality of your text through feedback and dialogue.

Responsible teachers: Niklas Harring & Urban Strandberg

6. Exam

The course includes a written examination. It is essential that you register for the exam in advance. Please, consult the course schedule for the exact time and location, as the exam will be conducted on site.

The exam will focus on your ability to critically reflect on the key components of your proposed Master's Thesis. You will be asked to respond to questions concerning:

- The formulation and relevance of your research question(s)
- The identification of a research gap
- The relationship between your proposed study and existing literature
- How your work is positioned within the broader theoretical landscape
- Your use and understanding of relevant theoretical perspectives

This examination is intended to help consolidate your thinking about your thesis project and assess your ability to articulate and defend its academic foundation.

Responsible teacher: Niklas Harring

7. Seminar and hand-in: tentative outline of a Master's Thesis

As the title suggests, this assignment requires you to draft a tentative outline for a Master's Thesis that is directly connected to the themes covered in this course. Specifically, it should address a topic related to European environmental and/or energy issues. You are expected to reflect on what you have learned during the course and use this knowledge as a foundation to formulate an interesting, clear, and academically rigorous research question. Your text should identify and critically summarize relevant scholarly literature, describe your potential contribution to the research field, and propose a structure for your study. This includes outlining an appropriate method of analysis and data collection, along with a justification for your methodological choices. You should also reflect on the potential findings of your study and discuss their significance within the broader academic and policy context.

While methodological considerations are central to the assignment, it is important to remain grounded in the empirical and theoretical dimensions of the environmental or energy issue you are addressing. One of the main objectives of this assignment is to train your ability to specify a well-defined research problem suitable for a (hypothetical) Master's Thesis. In writing your text, be sure to adhere to the skill outcomes, formal requirements, and academic style guidelines outlined below.

You will present your thesis outline during the final seminar using slides. As part of your preparation, you are expected to read all the texts produced by members of your assigned seminar group carefully and be ready to actively participate in the discussions. In addition to general participation, you will be assigned the role of commentator for two of your fellow students' papers. Together with another student, you will lead a critical and constructive discussion on each assigned paper, helping to identify strengths and suggest areas for improvement. To prepare as thoroughly as possible, please review the checklist provided below.

The purpose of the seminar is to develop your ability to argue orally and reflect critically on your ideas in dialogue with others. This collaborative discussion will strengthen your analytical and argumentative skills and give you valuable insights into how others approach similar topics, broadening your understanding of the course themes. Please note that your performance in the seminar, both in presenting your work and engaging with others, will have an impact on your final grade.

Scope: 2500 words.

Responsible teachers: Niklas Haring

Instructions

Instructions for Commentators

As a commentator, your role is to provide constructive and thoughtful feedback that contributes to a meaningful discussion of your assigned paper. Please follow the steps below in preparing for the seminar:

1. Begin by carefully reading the paper you have been assigned. Reflect on its central components, particularly:
 - The formulation and clarity of the research question
 - The theoretical framework and its relevance
 - The definition and use of key concepts
 - The feasibility of the project, including the proposed data, research design, and overall scope
2. Prepare a set of questions or discussion points that you would like to raise with the author during the seminar.
3. In your comments, highlight both the strengths of the paper and areas where it could be improved. Begin by pointing out what you find particularly strong, interesting, or well-developed. Then move on to constructive critique—explain clearly why you believe certain aspects could be improved, and suggest specific ways the author might strengthen their work. Your comments should aim to support the author’s development of the project. Where appropriate, ask clarifying questions that encourage the author to elaborate on ideas that may be underdeveloped or unclear. Remember, your primary task is to assess how well the author has fulfilled the assignment in relation to the given instructions.
4. The seminar should include a dialogue between the commentator and the author. Be prepared to engage in a focused, respectful discussion.
5. You are expected to read all the papers being discussed in your seminar group. For each, you should prepare at least one comment or question, even if you are not serving as the primary commentator.
6. After the discussion between the assigned commentator and the author, the floor will be open for questions and comments from the rest of the group.
7. As each paper will be discussed within a limited time frame, commentators are kindly asked to be concise and focus on their most important points.

Uploading texts and posters

Upload your paper and poster to the designated 'Paper/Poster' folder on Canvas (see separate instructions there) and check the schedule for deadlines.

In case of absence or failure to meet requirements

- If you are absent from the poster seminar but submitted a poster, you are to write a text of 1000 words commenting on and critically evaluating three of the other posters in the theme (1000 words altogether).
- If you are absent from the final seminar but submitted a paper, you are to write a text of 1000 words commenting on and critically evaluating three of the other papers in the theme (1000 words altogether).
- If you are unable to submit a paper/poster on time, you are referred to the re-take examination.
- If your paper/poster received a fail-grade, you are to submit a new version of the same paper/poster at the re-take examination, dealing with the problems pointed out in the comments to the paper/poster.

Databases and scientific journals

When working with these texts you need to search for scientific articles in various databases. The University of Gothenburg Library has a list of databases, which you are recommended to use in your work. See <http://www.ub.gu.se/sok/db/>. When using databases such as Social Sciences Citation Index (SSCI) you indicate e.g. what keywords you want to search (e.g. “renewable energy”, “wind power” “implementation” etc.) and you will find matching results (what keywords you type are of course highly important for the results) in journals of high scientific standard. You may also scroll journals that you for some reason may be especially interested in, i.e., if you suspect that the problem you are interested in has been discussed thoroughly in one or a few journals.

Rules and requirements regarding cheating and plagiarism

Attempts to deceive during examinations

An attempt to deceive during examinations means that a student has attempted to give an impression of their performance in a written exam or some of form of assessment that is not true. That is what is commonly referred to as cheating, or attempting to cheat. There are different kinds of attempts to deceive, such as plagiarism, prohibited aids and prohibited collaboration. Deception can also take other forms.

- **Plagiarism** means that a student has presented someone else's text or other material as if it were their own text or material.
- **Prohibited aid** means that a student has used aids, including AI, that were not permitted according to the instructions.
- **Prohibited collaboration** means that students have collaborated with each other in breach of the instructions.

Plagiarism: Copying material from the Internet, from books, journals, reports, or from a fellow student and then presenting it as one's own is strictly forbidden! Plagiarism is theft of someone else's work and will result in immediate fail of the assignment. Please note that the inclusion of a source in a bibliography list is not in itself sufficient attribution of another's work. In addition, unless it is a proper citation with a reference, any direct copying of text is forbidden. All submitted student work is screened with a program called *Ouriginal*, which compares a student's written work with published materials (including everything published on the internet) and all the work from prior students, to detect plagiarism. The material you have read and based your arguments and factual statements on should always be referenced using proper referencing technique. More information on references and how to avoid plagiarism can be found here: <https://studentportal.gu.se/english/help-and-guidance/search-read-write/reference-management-and-plagiarism>

Prohibited aid: All your submitted texts should be your own original writing, and not written by someone else or generated by AI. Unless there are specific instructions for the use of AI for an assignment, it should not be used and presented as your own text. The use of any tools to cheat during on campus exams (e.g. DISA) is also strictly forbidden.

Prohibited collaboration: students can discuss their work, but individual submissions must be your own original writing, and hence not too similar the work of others. Be extra careful to avoid using common notes from such collaborations.

Any kind of cheating on examinations is considered a serious offence. Proved or suspected cheating will be reported to the Disciplinary Committee of the University

of Gothenburg, in accordance with the procedure of disciplinary matters at the Department of Political Science.

The consequences may be severe for a student if found guilty. A student may be suspended from classes and campus for a determined time-period (from 3 weeks to half a year), which will result in a temporary suspension of all financial aid (including CSN) and may jeopardize a student's residence permit status. More information on disciplinary matters, including plagiarism and its consequences, can be found here: <https://studentportal.gu.se/english/study-environment-and-rules/disciplinary-matters/>

Equal Treatment

The Department of Political Science expects both staff and student to treat each other in a respectful manner. Our vision is that the Department should be a study- and working environment where diversity among staff and students is appreciated and where harassment and discrimination are not tolerated.

Equal treatment representative: Ulrika Möller ulrika.moller@pol.gu.se

Course evaluation

At the end of the course, you will be asked to fill in a course evaluation which will be sent to you by email.